Case Study – The "Request Money" Trap

The Crime: UPI Payment Fraud (The QR Code/Request Scam) UPI fraud involves tricking a victim into authorizing a transaction that moves money *out* of their account under the guise of receiving a payment or verifying an account.

How it Happens (Step-by-Step):

1. **The Bait:** The scammer poses as a buyer on a platform like OLX or a "Technical Support" officer from a bank/fintech app.
2. **The Hook:** They express urgent interest in a product you are selling or claim your account is "blocked" and requires a "Re. 1 verification."
3. **The Manipulation:** Instead of sending money, the scammer sends a **"Collect Request"** or a QR code via WhatsApp. They tell the victim, "Just scan this and enter your PIN to receive the payment."
4. **The Theft:** The moment the victim enters their UPI PIN, they are actually *authorizing* a debit. The money is instantly transferred to the scammer's "mule" account.

Who is Targeted: College students and young professionals are frequent targets because they are active on second-hand marketplaces and rely heavily on digital wallets.

Consequences: Beyond the immediate financial loss—which is often non-refundable because the user "authorized" it with a PIN—victims face significant stress and a loss of trust in digital systems.